

HKLMSOFTWARE Subkey

The software and Windows settings are stored on this key (in the default hardware profile). The majority of changes are made by application and system installers. It's organised by the software vendor (with subkeys for each), but it also has a "Windows" subkey for some Windows user interface settings, a "Classes" subkey for all registered associations from file extensions, MIME types, Object Classes IDs, and interfaces IDs (for OLE, COM/DCOM, and ActiveX) to the installed applications or DLLs that may be handling these types on the local machine (however, these associations are configurable for each user, see below (including the central certificates store used for authenticating, authorising or disallowing remote systems or services running outside of the local network domain)).

HKEY_CURRENT_CONFIG (HKCC)

This key stores information obtained during runtime; data in this key is not permanently kept on disc, but is regenerated at boot time. It's a handle to the key "HKEY LOCAL MACHINESystemCurrentControlSetHardware ProfilesCurrent," which is empty at first but is filled in at boot time by loading one of the other subkeys in "HKEY LOCAL MACHINESystemCurrentControlSetHardware Profiles."

HKEY_CLASSES_ROOT (HKCR)

This key stores information about registered programmes, including as file associations and OLE Object Class IDs, and links them to the applications that deal with them. HKCR is a collection of user-based HKCUSoftwareClasses and machine-based HKLMSoftwareClasses on Windows 2000 and later. If the same value appears in both subkeys, the one in HKCUSoftwareClasses takes precedence. The design allows COM objects to be registered by either the machine or the user. Unlike the HKCU hive, the user-specific classes hive is not part of a roaming user profile.

HKEY_USERS (HKU)

User hives are normally only loaded for presently logged-in users and contain subkeys matching to the HKEY CURRENT USER keys for each user profile actively loaded on the PC.

HKEY_CURRENT_USER (HKCU)

This key contains parameters specific to the user who is presently logged